

Add New User and Group

👤 Linux Lab: Add New User and Group

🎯 Goal

Learn how to:

- Create groups
- Create users
- Assign primary and secondary groups
- Verify configuration

⚙️ Step 1: Create Groups

Create two groups:

```
sudo groupadd dev
```

```
sudo groupadd support
```

Verify:

```
grep dev /etc/group
```

```
grep support /etc/group
```

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ sudo groupadd dev  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ grep dev /etc/group  
plugdev:x:46:kali  
netdev:x:101:kali  
dev:x:1004:  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$
```

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ sudo groupadd support  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ grep support /etc/group  
support:x:1003:  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$
```

⚙️ Step 2: Create User

Create user john with:

- Home directory
- Primary group = dev
- Secondary group = support

```
sudo useradd -m -g dev -G support john
```

Verify: id John

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ sudo useradd John -m -g dev -G support  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ id John  
uid=1003(John) gid=1004(dev) groups=1004(dev),1003(support)  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$
```

⚙️ Step 3: Set Password

```
sudo passwd john
```

Example:

New password:

Retype new password:

```
passwd: password updated successfully
```

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ sudo passwd John  
New password:  
Retype new password:  
passwd: password updated successfully  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$
```

⚙️ Step 4: Verify Home Directory

ls /home

Expected:

John

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ ls /home  
Anamika John kali testuser  
  
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$
```

⚙️ Step 5: Switch to User

su - john

Check:

whoami

Output:

John

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
$ su - John  
Password:  
$ whoami  
John  
$
```

⚙️ Step 6: Verify Group Membership

groups john

Output:

john : dev support

```
$ groups John
John : dev support
$
```

□ Cleanup (Optional)

Delete user and home directory:

```
sudo userdel -r john
```

Delete groups:

```
sudo groupdel dev
```

```
sudo groupdel support
```

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$ ls /home
Anamika John kali testuser

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo userdel -r John
userdel: John mail spool (/var/mail/John) not found

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo groupdel dev

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo groupdel support

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$ id John
id: 'John': no such user

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$
```

Interview Explanation

"I created Linux users and groups, assigned primary and secondary groups, configured passwords, verified membership using id and groups, and validated home directory creation."

Bonus Challenge

Create:

- Group: cloud
- Group: linux
- User: anamika
- Primary group: cloud
- Secondary group: linux

Lesson Learned : If there is already existing user and you want to assign them to a group you use the usermod command check below:

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ ls /home
Anamika  kali

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ sudo groupadd Linux

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ sudo groupadd Cloud

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ grep Cloud /etc/group
Cloud:x:1004:

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ grep Linux /etc/group
Linux:x:1003:

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ sudo useradd Anamika -g Cloud -G Linux
useradd: user 'Anamika' already exists

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ sudo groupadd Anamika -g Cloud -G Linux
groupadd: invalid group ID 'Cloud' ❌

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ sudo usermod -g Cloud -G Linux Anamika

(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ id Anamika
uid=1002(Anamika) gid=1004(Cloud) groups=1004(Cloud),1003(Linux)
```